FOREWORD

Iron Man was a life-changing experience. The best way to describe it would be that we were building the hot rod *while* we were racing it. It is the case, much of the time, that these movies never actually lock a script until they're shot and cut. They require an incredible amount of gut instinct and many talented collaborative partners. These types of movies are not made from a script as much as a mélange of storyboards, notes on cocktail napkins, dialogue scrawled on the back of the day's sides and keyframe drawings hung on the set for inspiration. The movie is slowly culled from both written and drawn elements that together inform the story.

The talented writers that we employed contributed a great deal early on in the process and, thanks to a strong and storied guild, were recognized in the front credits. There are, however, many others who contributed equally to the vision of the film, and it is to those unsung heroes that this book is dedicated. They are not, however, who this book is *for*. It is *for* the aspiring filmmakers. Both the ones chasing down their dreams and the ones who don't yet realize they will ever actually attempt to do this for a living. That was me. The kid reading *Starlog*. The fan who was curious about how the Spinners in *Blade Runner* flew or if the actual Enterprise miniature looked anything like the Revell one that I kluged together with Testors glue. I enjoyed the movies so much that looking behind the curtain didn't ruin them for me. Quite the contrary. It made me love and appreciate them that much more.

There was a moment in post-production when everything seemed very tenuous and bleak. We hadn't settled into a satisfying cut, and the effects weren't yet landing right. It is an awful period in the process when, after years of hard work, you are struck with the lingering fear that, in spite of unflagging dedication and meticulous planning, the whole thing might go pear-shaped. It was around that point that Kevin Feige (producer and Marvel boss) gave me a copy of *The Making of Star Wars*. It documented interviews and photos done behind the scenes long before the film was ever a hit. When all seemed to be going very wrong. But it didn't. It went quite well, most would say, when all was said and done. Reading this book gave me the one thing most required for the making of a successful movie (and life, for that matter). Faith.

This phenomenon is so common it is indeed predictable. You plan and scheme. Some things work out, many don't. In the end, the movie either works or it doesn't, and you are never even aware of where that tipping point is when you pass it. Both success and failure hit you with equal surprise. It is best, therefore, to concentrate on making the movie. For those interested in making the movie, read on.

And thank you Stan Winston, wherever you are.

—JON FAVREAU